

Waterfront Buyer Due Diligence Checklist

Eastern Fort Lauderdale waterfront residences

Prepared by Mia Sanabria · (954) 540-0358 ·
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FL Sales Associate License #SL3405877 · Fort
Lauderdale, FL

A working checklist for serious buyers of Fort Lauderdale waterfront residences. The list is organized by the diligence sequence Mia uses to structure private buyer-side conversations — survey first, water and dock data next, insurance underwriting before the offer. Each item is a question to bring to a licensed specialist, not a substitute for one.

Who this is for

Serious buyers of Eastern Fort Lauderdale waterfront residences who want a private diligence sequence before making an offer.

How to use this document

Work through the sections in order — survey first, then water and dock data, then insurance underwriting. Bring each question to the relevant licensed specialist; this checklist coordinates the conversation, it does not replace expert findings.

Parcel basics

- ☐ Confirm folio number on the Broward County Property Appraiser record.
- ☐ Pull the legal description and confirm it matches the current survey on file.
- ☐ Cross-reference the address with the City of Fort Lauderdale property records.
- ☐ Note the parcel's zoning designation and any historic-district overlays.

Survey and legal description

- ☐ Order or request the most recent boundary survey from the seller's file.
- ☐ Confirm lot frontage on the canal, lot depth, and any setbacks of record.
- ☐ Identify any easements (drainage, utility, dockage, shared seawall).
- ☐ Flag any encroachments visible on the survey for legal review.

Dockage capacity

- ☐ Verify dock length, beam clearance, and fendering against the seller's dock permits.
- ☐ Confirm pile count and condition; request the most recent dock inspection if available.
- ☐ Note lift capacity, lift age, and any service history of the lift mechanism.
- ☐ Photograph the dock at low tide to confirm usable depth at the slip.

Seawall, cap, and tiebacks

- ☐ Request the seawall inspection report (cap condition, tieback integrity, prior remediation).
- ☐ Note the seawall's installation year and any documented repairs.
- ☐ Confirm whether any seawall reserve fund or HOA reserve covers shared sections.
- ☐ Walk the seawall at low tide with the marine contractor if the inspection is older than 5 years.

Canal, turning basin, bridge clearance

- ☐ Measure canal width at the residence and at the nearest turning basin.
- ☐ Confirm bridge clearances along the route to Port Everglades (or Hillsboro Inlet for residences farther north).
- ☐ Identify each drawbridge on the route and its current operating schedule.
- ☐ Confirm route-to-inlet count: number of fixed bridges (zero is the deepwater premium) and number of opening bridges.

Flood zone, elevation, prior claims

- ☐ Pull the FEMA flood zone designation for the parcel.
- ☐ Request the elevation certificate; confirm the lowest finished floor elevation and reference datum.
- ☐ Request prior-claim history (a CLUE report from the seller or carrier where available).
- ☐ Compare flood-zone designation against any recent floodplain map revisions.

Insurance underwriting sequence

- ☐ Engage a Florida-licensed insurance broker before the offer goes in, not after.
- ☐ Request quotes against the seller's recent 4-point inspection and wind-mitigation report.
- ☐ Confirm whether the parcel qualifies for private windstorm coverage or routes to Citizens.
- ☐ Note any underwriting conditions that would require remediation before binding.

Systems inspection

- ☐ Order the 4-point inspection: roof, electrical, plumbing, HVAC.
- ☐ Order a wind-mitigation inspection to capture credits.
- ☐ Walk the property with a licensed home inspector experienced in waterfront residences.
- ☐ For older renovations, request a permit-history pull to confirm closed permits.

Renovation and permit history

- ☐ Pull the City of Fort Lauderdale building-permit history (LauderBuild).
- ☐ Confirm every renovation has a closed permit; note any open or expired permits.
- ☐ For dock or seawall work in the past 10 years, confirm the marine-contractor permit closed.
- ☐ Note any HOA architectural-review records for cosmetic or structural changes.

Specialist roster

Mia coordinates the introductions; the specialists' findings — not Mia's summaries — are the ground truth.

- ☐ Licensed home inspector with waterfront-residence experience.
- ☐ Florida-licensed marine contractor (dock, seawall, lift).
- ☐ Land surveyor for boundary, elevation, and as-built confirmations.
- ☐ Florida-licensed insurance broker familiar with coastal underwriting.
- ☐ Mortgage advisor (when financing), with coastal-Florida portfolio experience.
- ☐ Title insurance / closing attorney with Broward County jurisdiction.

Documents to request

- ☐ Boundary survey (most recent)
- ☐ Elevation certificate
- ☐ Dock and seawall inspection reports
- ☐ 4-point inspection report
- ☐ Wind-mitigation report
- ☐ Permit history (LauderBuild)
- ☐ HOA architectural-review records (if applicable)
- ☐ Prior insurance claim history (CLUE report)

Red flags / questions to ask

- Open or expired permits on the property record.
- Seawall inspection older than 5 years with no recent walk-through.
- Dock work in the past 10 years without a closed marine permit.
- Elevation certificate dated before a recent floodplain map revision.
- Insurance broker declines to quote pre-offer.
- Seller refuses to provide a CLUE / prior-claim history.

Notes

Property address: _____

Folio number: _____

Scheduled inspection date: _____

Insurance broker assigned: _____

Specialist roster confirmed: _____

Other: _____

Next step

Begin a Private Buyer Brief

<https://miasanabriarealtor.trueidea.com/contact/?intent=buyer-brief&market=fort-lauderdale&source=pdf-buyer-checklist>

Source ledger

Broward County Property Appraiser — <https://web.bcpa.net/>

City of Fort Lauderdale property records — <https://www.fortlauderdale.gov/>

City of Fort Lauderdale LauderBuild permit portal

FEMA Flood Map Service Center — <https://msc.fema.gov/>

Florida OIR — [windstorm/4-point/wind-mitigation](#) guidance

MIA-SITE Cycle 18 source ledger — [docs/CYCLE_18_FORT_LAUDERDALE_POMPANO_RESEARCH_LEDGER.md](#)

Disclaimer

Not legal, insurance, inspection, marine survey, engineering, tax, or lending advice. The information in this document is a working checklist drawn from Mia Sanabria's coordination experience with Eastern Fort Lauderdale waterfront residences. Mia coordinates the engagement of licensed specialists — inspectors, surveyors, marine contractors, insurance brokers, lenders, title agents — whose findings, not this document, are the ground truth for any specific residence.

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